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Public Speaking

Lecture 45: Leadership Skills

Part I

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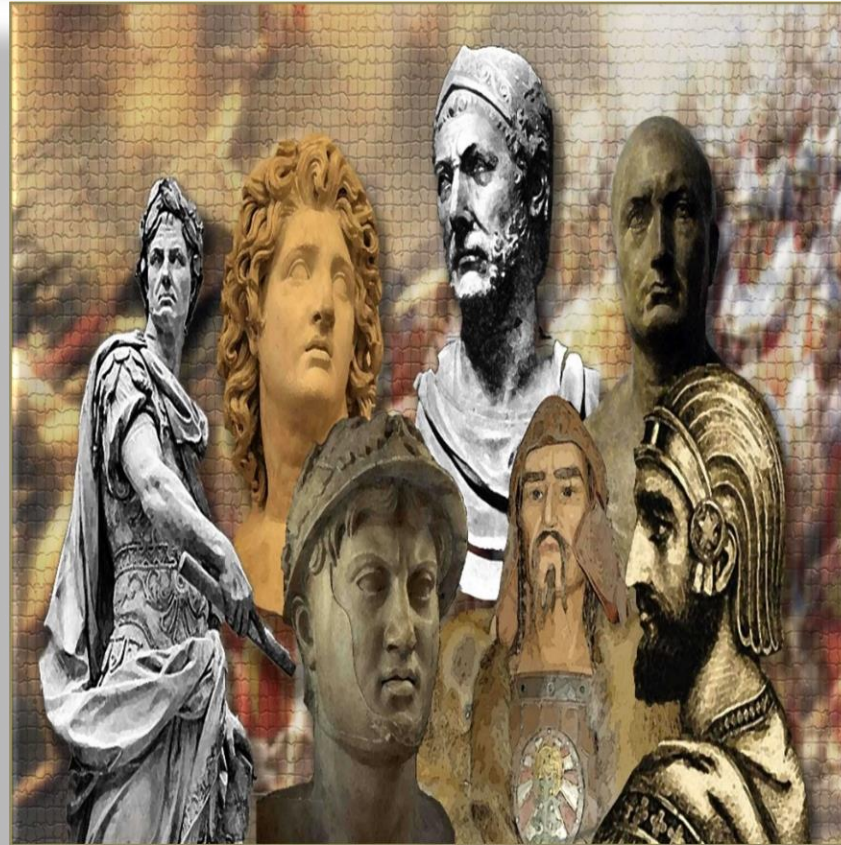


What is Leadership?

Leadership skills can be understood as the tools, behaviours, attitudes and capabilities that are required in a person to be successful at motivating, influencing and directing others.

“Leadership is the art of mastering change ... the ability to mobilize others’ efforts in new directions.”

- Rosabeth Ross Kanter

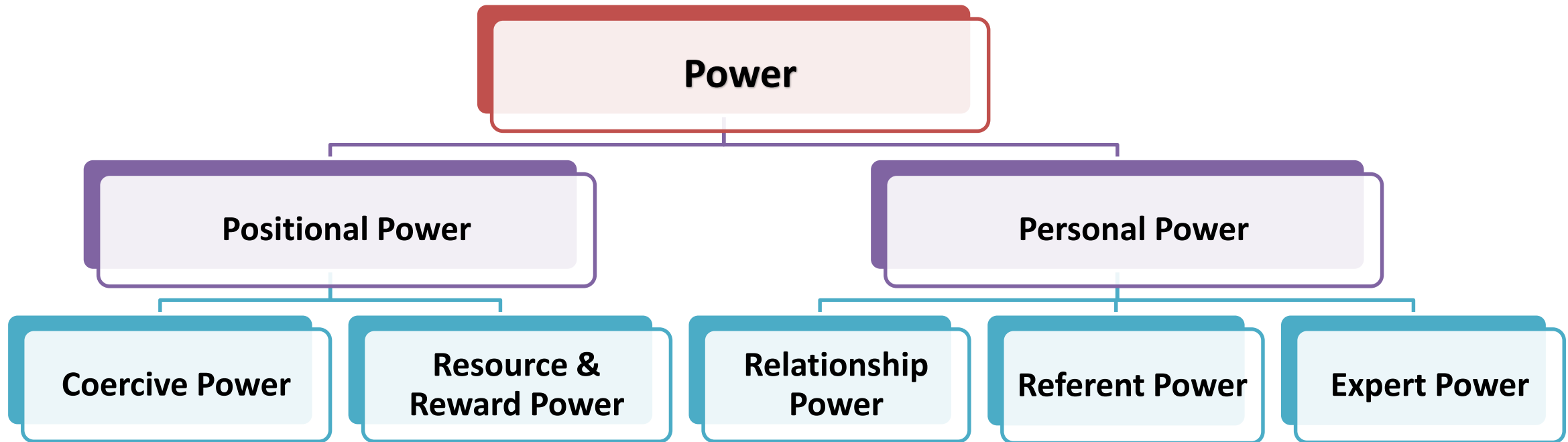


“Leaders are made, they are not born. They are made by hard effort, which is the price which all of us must pay to achieve any goal that is worthwhile.”

- Vince Lombardi

Leadership and Power

- ❑ Leadership involves the act of influencing the followers to act in accordance with their leader's wishes; and power is defined as the ability to influence the actions of others, or to produce an effect. Thereby, we can surmise that **leadership involves effective use of power**.
- ❑ Successful leadership involves the leader's ability to communicate to the followers the powers possessed by him/her, and the skill to optimally build upon the powers possessed.



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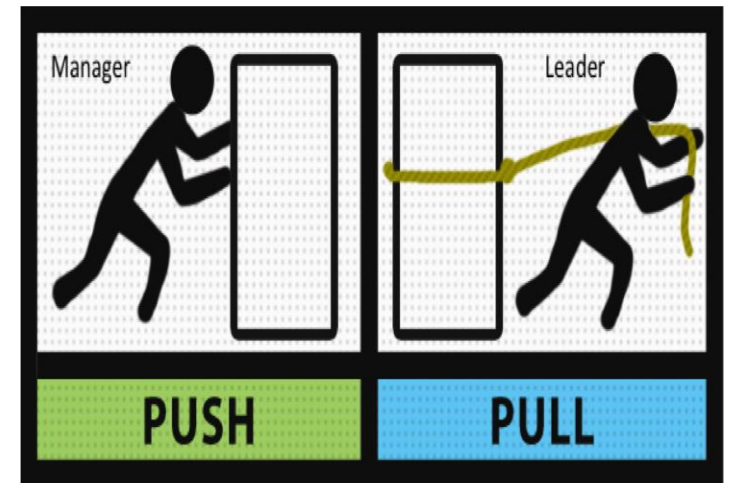
- ❑ **Positional Power:** The power which stems from holding a certain title, rank, position or job in an organization.
 - ❑ **Coercive Power:** Compliance through threats and punishments.
 - ❑ **Resource and Reward Power:** Control and manage organizational resources and assets; and the power to honour rewards upon the employees for their achievements.
- ❑ **Personal Power:** The power which stems from the leader's intrinsic worth, skills and competencies.
 - ❑ **Relationship Power:** It is derived from the followers' respect, admiration and trust for their leader emanating from a positive relationship between the leader and his/her followers.
 - ❑ **Referent Power:** The power based on a high degree of fandom and fondness for the power-holder; for instance – in case of celebrities and charismatic leaders.
 - ❑ **Expert Power:** “**Knowledge is power**” – **Francis Bacon**. The power which is derived from one's knowledge, specialization or expertise and one's ability to dispense valuable output in a task.

Leadership Versus Management

Warren Benis, in his book '*On Becoming a Leader*', differentiates a leader from a manager in the following respects:

Leader	Manager
Has followers	Has subordinates
Focuses on people	Focuses on system & structure
Inspires trust	Seeks control
Innovates new visions/ ideas	Implements change/ ideas
Develops the organization	Develops people
Makes new policies and rules	Implements rules and policies
Refines & strategizes the vision	Plans and Budgets
Asks questions	Gives directions
Motivates and inspires	Instructs

**“Leadership focuses on doing the right things;
Management focuses on doing things right.”**
– Stephen Covey



**“Management is execution;
leadership is inspiration.”**
– John Baldoni

Leadership: Theories

Trait Theory

- Popular during 1920s
- Leaders are born, possessing inherent traits.

Behavior Theory

- Popular during 1950s
- Leadership ability can be developed by learning certain effective behaviors.

Situational Theory

- Popular during 2020s
- Appropriate leadership behavior is contingent on the situation and on the followers.

Trait Leadership Theory

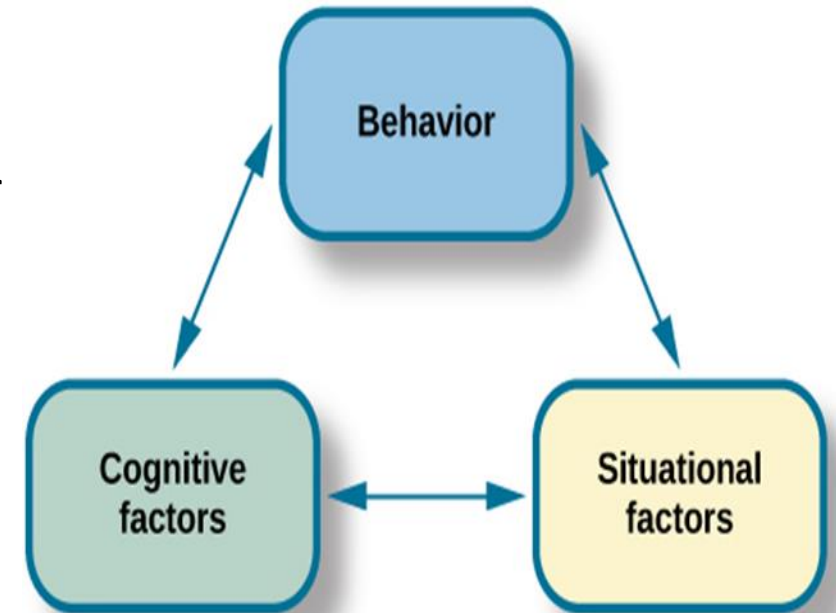
- ❑ Based on the '**Great Man Theory**'; assumes that leadership is **pre-determined** by possession of specific inherent personality traits.
- ❑ In terms of psychology, a trait is a stable, inflexible characteristic that is inherited and lasts throughout one's entire life.
- ❑ Focus was laid on searching for the right traits, which distinguished leaders from followers.
- ❑ It argues that the potential of leadership is inherited – "Great Leaders are born, and not made".

Limitations – Researches revealed that it is impossible to curate an exact set of universal leadership traits due to cultural plurality and contextual variations.



Behaviour Leadership Theory

- ❑ Since human personality traits are immeasurable entities, researchers shifted their focus to examine behaviours that embodied certain personality traits.
- ❑ Behaviour can be defined as **observable actions** of an individual which are either governed by one's inherent traits or are modified by training and development.
- ❑ The theorists focus on observing the behavioural models and patterns of great leaders to formulate the parameters of ideal leadership behaviour
- ❑ Contrary to the trait theory, this model argues that leadership ability can be acquired through **training and practice**, and is not an inherent attribute.



Behaviour Leadership Theory (contd.)

Robert Blake and **Jane Mouton**, in their book *The Managerial Grid: The Key to Leadership Excellence* (1964), identified five kinds of leadership behaviours based on the variables of **concern for subordinates** and **concern for tasks**:

Country Club Style

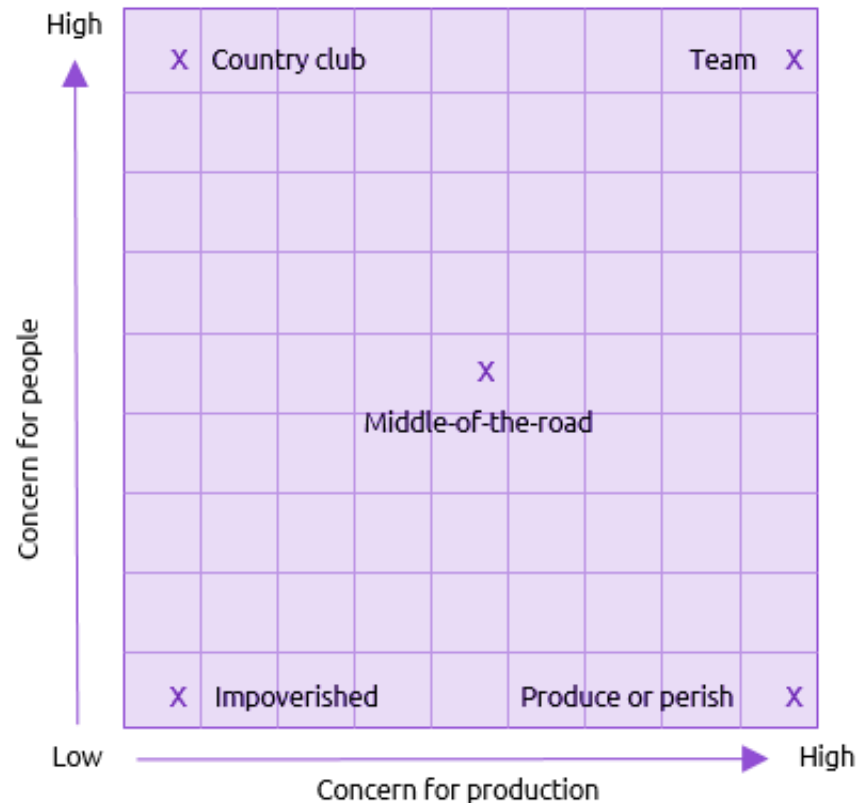
- Focuses on creating friendly ambience
- Lower task output

Middle-of-the-road Style

- Ineffective compromise with not enough concern - neither for followers nor for tasks

Impoverished Style

- Egoistic & obsessed leaders
- Least effective approach to leadership



Team Style

- Ideal leadership behaviour
- Collaborative approach
- Optimum Productivity

Produce or Perish Style

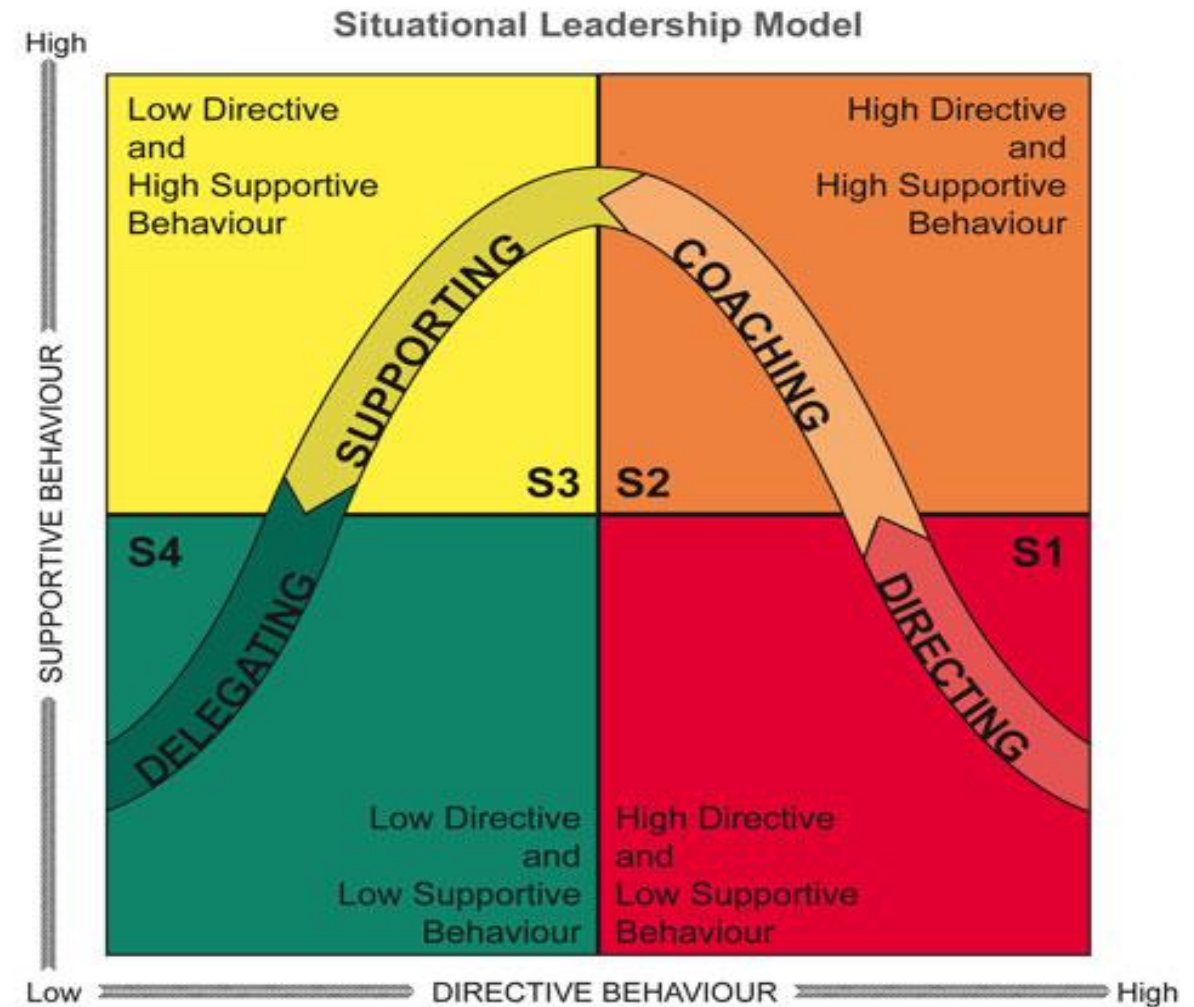
- Autocratic leadership style
- Might appear effective for short-term
- Not sustainable in the long run

Situational Leadership Theory

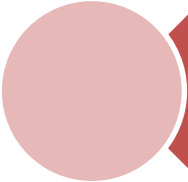
- ❑ Developed by **Paul Hersey** and **Ken Blanchard** (*Management of Organizational Behaviour: Utilizing Human Resources*, 1982).
- ❑ Appropriate leadership behaviour is contingent on the situational context and on the followers of the leader.
- ❑ The effectiveness of a leader depends not only on his/her qualities and skills, but also on the
 - ❑ Attitude of the followers
 - ❑ Their acceptance of the leader
 - ❑ Their skills and abilities to accomplish a specific task
 - ❑ Their willingness to perform the task
- ❑ This model defines **four styles of leadership: Delegating, Supporting, Coaching and Directing.**
- ❑ The appropriateness of the styles to be adopted depends upon **the task at hand** and on **the ability and willingness of the subordinates.**

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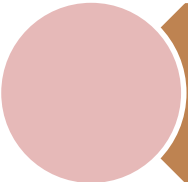
1. **Directing:** The 'Telling' style. It comprises instructing followers about what, how, where and when to perform a task. Involves one-way communication.
2. **Coaching:** Follows two-way communication, where the leader is attentive to the ideas and suggestions of the followers, while directing them.
3. **Supporting:** Highly supportive and encouraging attitude of the leader towards the followers. Greater involvement of the followers in decision-making on the tasks.
4. **Delegating:** Minimal direction and support offered by the leader. The subordinates are capable enough to run the show on their own.



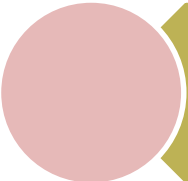
Leadership Styles



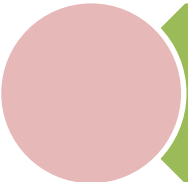
Authoritarian



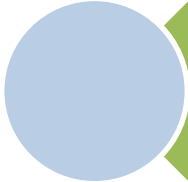
Laissez-faire



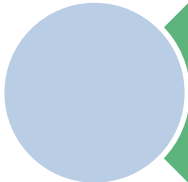
Charismatic



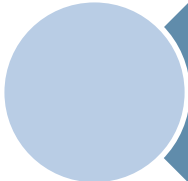
Transformational



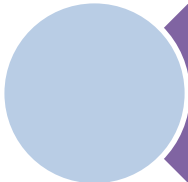
Democratic



Bureaucratic



Transactional



Servant-leadership

Authoritarian Leadership Style

Characteristics

- Exercises absolute control over the project
- Prefers a clear structure
- Has rigid expectations
- Focuses primarily on the completion of task
- Autocratic decision making

When to Use

- In need of quick results/decisions
- For short-term, complex or technical tasks
- For tedious and mechanical tasks which might lead to low motivation
- In case of a larger workforce

Advantages

- Useful style for projects which need to be implemented in a hurry
- Delivers quicker results
- Higher productivity in case of unmotivated employees

Disadvantages

- Stifles the creativity and responsiveness of the subordinates
- De-skills the workforce in the long run
- Demotivates the employees or makes them over-reliant on the leader

Democratic Leadership Style

Characteristics

- Shared responsibility among the employees
- The leader progresses on the feedback of the followers
- Focuses primarily on the development of harmonious interpersonal relationships
- Democratic decision making

When to Use

- In tasks that demand high creative thinking
- In projects that aim at training the workforce and developing their skills
- When the workforce is competent and eager to contribute
- When there is ample time to accomplish the task

Advantages

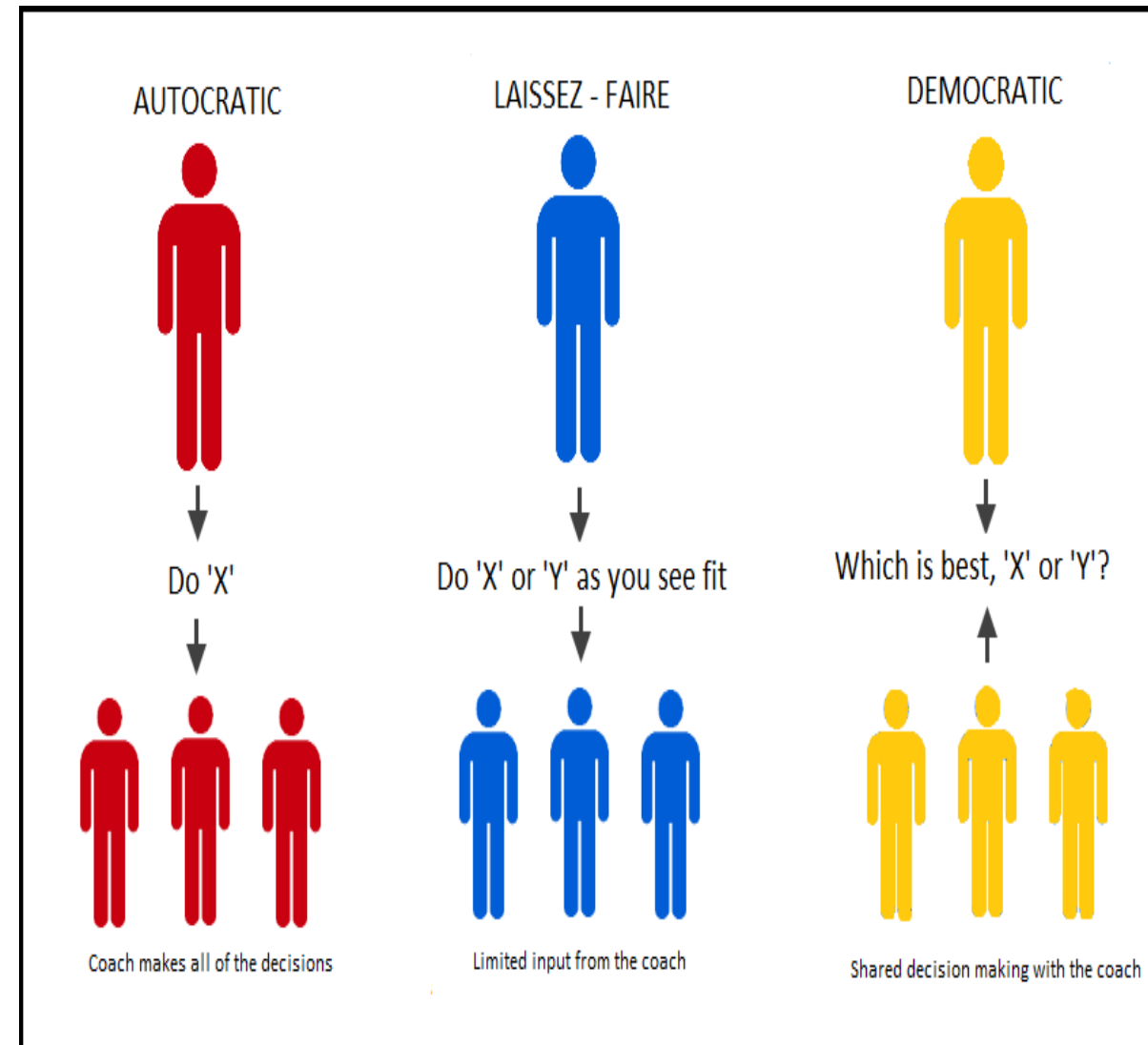
- Makes use of the full potential of the team
- Facilitates individual empowerment
- Creates positive, collaborative, and productive work environment
- Inspires changes rather than imposing them

Disadvantages

- Decision-making becomes a tardy and time-consuming process
- Fails to perform in high-pressure situations
- May lead to haphazard randomness in the group due to lack of an absolute control

Laissez-faire Leadership Style

- ❑ *Laissez-faire*: Etymology – **French**; means ‘**leave alone**’, i.e. to let things take their own course without any interference.
- ❑ Laissez-faire approach refers to a **delegative style of leadership**, in which the followers are endowed with ultimate freedom to use their knowledge and creativity to make decisions and meet the goals..
- ❑ This style is recommendable only when the employees/followers are well-educated, highly skilled and experienced with the task assigned and intrinsically motivated.



Bureaucratic Leadership Style

- ☐ Followed in older organizations, which tends to resist any change or evolution in their hierarchical structure within.
- ☐ Focus lies on ensuring that the employees **comply with the rules** and **follow the procedures**.
- ☐ The work environment is organized in a **clear formal structure**, with distinct positions and defined roles of the leader and the employees.
- ☐ This style works well when **consistent output** is required out of **repetitive tasks**; in tasks demanding **high regulation and control** and a strict division of labour.
- ☐ **Lack of creativity** in performing tasks can gradually de-humanize and demotivate the workforce.
- ☐ The absence of an interactive work culture can lead to **more competition** within the organization, and **may breed rivalry** among the colleagues.

Charismatic Leadership Style

Why charismatic leaders are effective

Charismatic leaders challenge the status quo by using charisma as a source of authority.



Emotional impact

Charismatic leaders are visionary, appeal to emotions, and effectively arouse followers' motives.



Strong values

Charismatic leaders are role models who set an example by demonstrating desired behaviors.



Powerful language

Charismatic leaders gain credibility from communicating in a likeable, trustworthy, and knowledgeable way.



Meaningful goals

Charismatic leaders use framing techniques to create a vision worth aspiring to.



Facing adversity

Charismatic leaders use their foundation of trust, empowerment and authenticity to help overcome obstacles.

See for example House, R. J., & Shamir, B. (1993). Toward the integration of transformational, charismatic and visionary theories. In Chermers, M. M. & Ayman, R. (Eds). Leadership Theory and Research: Perspectives and Directions. San Diego: Academic Press.

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Transactional Leadership Style

- ❑ Functions upon a clear and definite chain of command by the leader, who owns **the sole authority and responsibility**.
- ❑ The role of the employees is restricted to **a blind obedience to the instructions and commands** of the leader.
- ❑ The leader motivates the subordinates primarily by the **system of rewards and punishments**.
- ❑ The transactional leader tend to perform as a **careful monitor** to the rules, procedures and standards.
- ❑ High clarity in directions and instructions pertaining to the task at hand, but **less creativity** in solving organizational problems.
- ❑ Focus is primarily upon the completion of task by **strict adherence to the conventional organizational norms**.
- ❑ Creativity boost, skill-development and empowerment of the employees is put on the back foot.

Transformational Leadership Style

- ❑ Defined by researchers **J. M. Burns** and **B. M. Bass** during 1970s
- ❑ To *transform* the goals, vision and mission of the followers and the organization at large towards a positive direction
- ❑ The ideal transformational leader ought to **inspire and motivate the followers** by:
 - ❑ Creating a **compelling vision**
 - ❑ Being able to **sell that vision** productively
 - ❑ Appealing to **higher ideal and values**
 - ❑ Building **cordial relationships with followers** as their teacher, mentor or coach



Transformational Leadership Style: Components



Servant-Leadership Style

- ❑ Term was coined by **Robert K. Greenleaf** in his essay *The Servant as Leader* (1970):

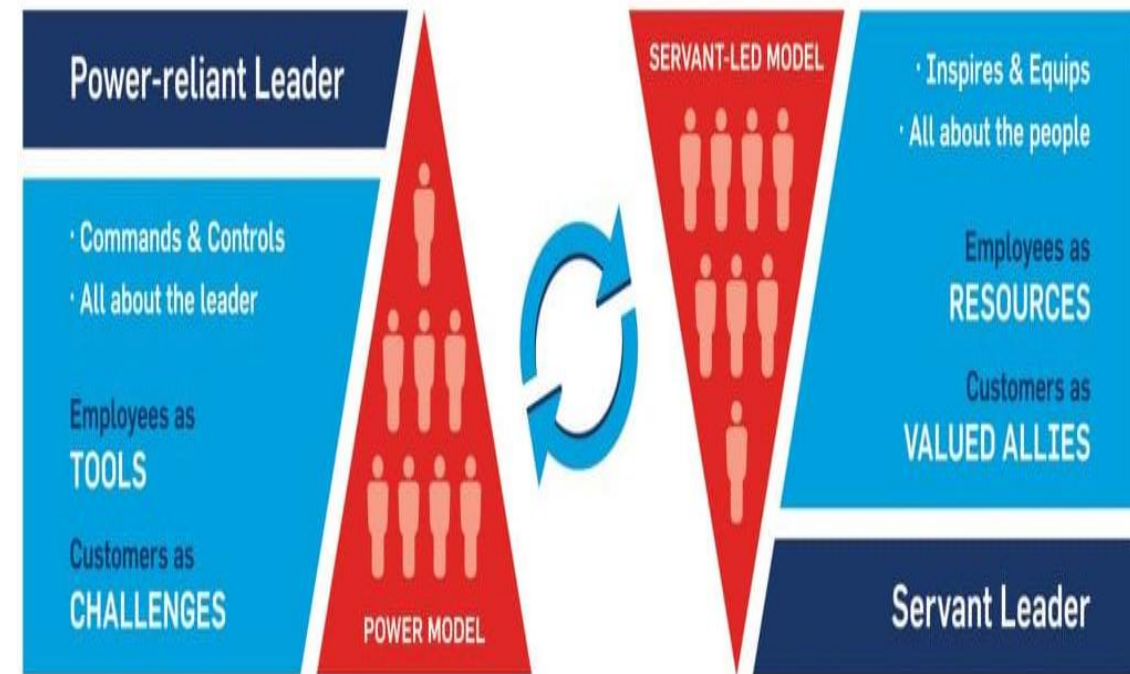
“The servant-leader is servant first... It begins with the natural feeling that one wants to serve, to serve first. Then conscious choice brings one to aspire to lead. That person is sharply different from one who is leader first, perhaps because of the need to assuage an unusual power drive or to acquire material possessions...The leader-first and the servant-first are two extreme types. Between them there are shadings and blends that are part of the infinite variety of human nature.”

- ❑ The primary goals of Servant-Leadership mode are:

- ✓ The genuine desire to serve others
- ✓ To prioritise collective good over self-interests
- ✓ Commitment to enhance personal growth and development of the followers

- ❑ *“The highest destiny of the individual is to serve rather than to rule.”*

- **Albert Einstein**



The Six Leadership Styles (Goleman)

	Commanding	Visionary	Affiliative	Democratic	Pacesetting	Coaching
The leader's modus operandi	Demands immediate compliance	Mobilizes people toward a vision	Creates harmony and builds emotional bonds	Forges consensus through participation	Sets high standards for performance	Develops people for the future
The style in a phrase	"Do what I tell you."	"Come with me."	"People come first."	"What do you think?"	"Do as I do, now"	"Try this."
Underlying emotional intelligence competencies	Drive to achieve, initiative, self-control	Self-confidence, empathy, change catalyst	Empathy, building relationships, communication	Collaboration, team leadership, communication	Conscientiousness, drive to achieve, initiative	Developing others, empathy, self-awareness
When the style works best	In a crisis, to kick start a turnaround, or with problem employees	When changes require a new vision, or when a clear direction is needed	To heal rifts in a team or to motivate people during stressful circumstances	To build buy-in or consensus, or to get input from valuable employees	To get quick results from a highly motivated and competent team	To help an employee improve performance or develop long-term strengths
Overall impact on climate	Negative	Most strongly positive	Positive	Positive	Negative	Positive

Goleman, Daniel, "Leadership that Gets Results" Harvard Business Review. March-April 2000 p. 82-83.

“A good leader inspires people to have confidence in him, a great leader inspires people to have confidence in themselves.”
– Eleanor Roosevelt

Thank You

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